



GROUP THEORY AND PROCESS

Chapter – 5

GROUPS

Group - two or more individuals, interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives

- **Formal group** - One defined by the organization's structure, with designated work assignments establishing tasks.
- In formal groups, the behaviors team members should engage in are stipulated by and directed toward the organizational goal
- **Informal group** is neither formally structured nor organizationally determined.
- Informal groups are natural formations in the work environment that appear in response to the need for social contact

The Group Development Model

The Five-Stage Model

1. The first stage, **forming stage**, is characterized by a great deal of **uncertainty** about the group's purpose, structure, and leadership.

Members “test the waters” to determine what types of behaviors are acceptable.

This stage is complete when members have begun to think of themselves as part of a group.

2. The **storming stage** is one of intragroup conflict.

Members accept the existence of the group but resist the constraints it imposes on individuality.

There is conflict over who will control the group.

This stage is complete when there is a relatively clear hierarchy of leadership within the group

The Group Development Model

The Five-Stage Model

3. **Norming Stage**: close relationships develop and the group demonstrates cohesiveness. There is now a strong sense of group identity and camaraderie.

This stage is complete when the group structure solidifies and the group has assimilated a common set of expectations of what defines correct member behavior

4. **Performing**: The structure at this point is fully functional and accepted.

Group energy has moved from getting to know and understand each other to performing the task at hand

The Group Development Model

The Five-Stage Model

5. **Adjourning stage (For Temporary Groups)**: the **adjourning stage** is for wrapping up activities and preparing to disband.

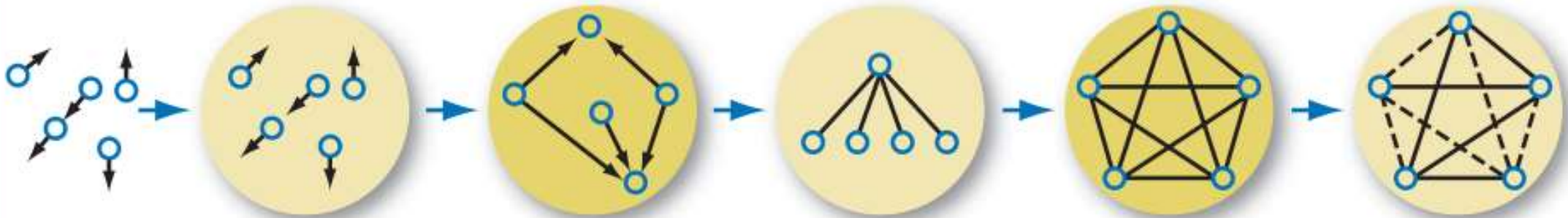
Some group members are upbeat, basking in the group's accomplishments.

Others may be depressed over the loss of camaraderie and friendships gained during the work group's life

The Group Development Model

Exhibit 9-1

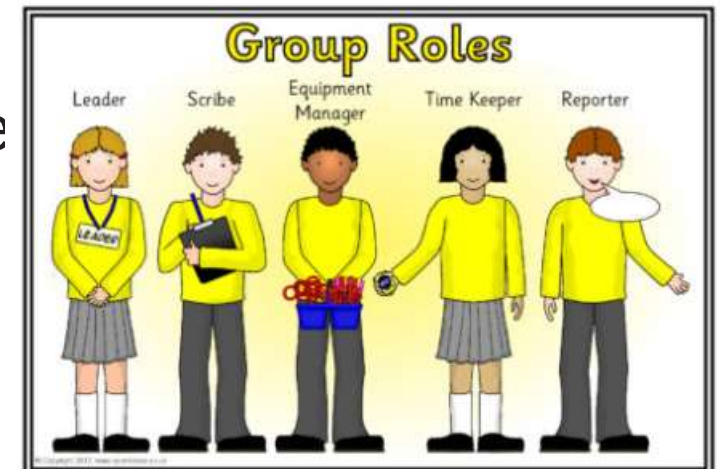
Stages of Group Development



Group Properties

Group Property 1 : Roles

- Set of expected behavior patterns attributed to someone occupying a given position in a social unit.
- Each individual has to take up a role in the group, for the group to function well
- Role clarity is essential for effective role performance



Group Properties

Group Property 2 : Norms

- Acceptable standards of behavior shared by their members that express **what they ought and ought not to do** under certain circumstances.
- When agreed to and accepted by the group, norms influence members' behavior with a minimum of external controls
- *Performance norm*
- *Appearance norms* (dress codes, unspoken rules about when to look busy)
- *social arrangement norms* (with whom to eat lunch, whether to form friendships on and off the job)
- *Resource allocation norms*
(assignment of difficult jobs, distribution of resources like pay or equipment)

GROUP NORMS



GROUPS & NORMS

From the Hawthorne Studies, researchers gained valuable insights into how individual behavior is influenced by group norms. They observed that a group of workers determined the level of fair output and established norms for individual work rates that conformed to the output. To enforce the group norms, workers used sarcasm, ridicule, and even physical force to influence individual behaviors that were not acceptable to the group.

Researchers also learned that money was less a factor in determining worker output than were group standards, sentiments, and security.



Source: Hawthorne Works Factory of Morton College.

Group Properties

Group Property 3: **Status**

- a socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others
- **What entails status :**
- **The power a person wields over others.** Because they likely control the group's resources, people who control the outcomes tend to be perceived as high status.
- **2. A person's ability to contribute to a group's goals.** People whose contributions are critical to the group's success tend to have high status.
- **3. An individual's personal characteristics.** Someone whose personal characteristics are positively valued by the group (good looks, intelligence, money, or a friendly personality) typically has a higher status than someone with fewer valued attributes.

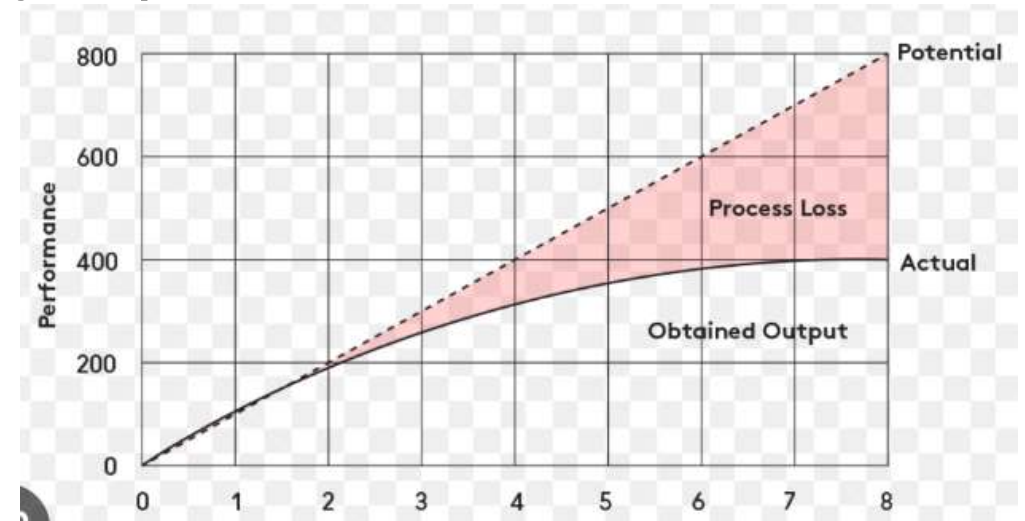


Group Properties

Group Property 4: Size

- Does the size of a group affect the group's overall behavior
Smaller groups are found to be faster in terms of completing tasks
- Large group , however, are found to be better in problem solving
- Social Loafing is a concern with respect to group size

social loafing *The tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than when working individually.*



Group Properties

Group Property 5: **Cohesiveness**

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Cohesiveness—the degree to which members are attracted to each other and motivated to stay in the group

Some groups are cohesive because

- The members have spent a great deal of time together
- the group's small size facilitates high interaction
- external threats have brought members close together

Cohesiveness and productivity norms have an influence on productivity

Group Properties

Group Property 5: Cohesiveness

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Exhibit 9-6

**Relationship Between Group Cohesiveness,
Performance Norms, and Productivity**

		Cohesiveness	
		High	Low
Performance Norms	High	High productivity	Moderate productivity
	Low	Low productivity	Moderate to low productivity

Group Decision Making



GROUP DECISION MAKING

- Group decision-making (also known as collaborative decision-making or collective decision-making) is a situation faced when individuals collectively make a choice from the alternatives before them.
- The decision is then no longer attributable to any single individual who is a member of the group
- **Strengths of Group Decision Making**
 - *more complete information and knowledge.*
 - diverse views
 - acceptance of a solution

GROUP DECISION MAKING

- **Weaknesses of Group Decision Making**
- *Time consuming*
- Conformity pressure
- dominance of a group member (if exists)

GROUP DECISION MAKING TECHNIQUES

1. Brainstorming

A creative group technique where members freely suggest ideas without judgment. It encourages a flow of diverse thoughts to solve a problem or generate options.

2. Delphi Technique

A structured communication method where experts respond to questionnaires in multiple rounds. Feedback is shared anonymously to reach a consensus.

3. Nominal Group Technique (NGT)

A structured method where individuals first generate ideas independently and then discuss as a group. Ideas are ranked or voted on to reach a decision.

4. Consensus Decision Making

A collaborative process where the group works together to reach an agreement that everyone can support. It emphasizes group unity and shared commitment.

5. Majority Rule

Decisions are made based on the preference of the majority of group members. It is quick and democratic but may overlook minority opinions.

GROUP DECISION MAKING — RELATED CONCEPTS

- **Groupthink**
- It relates to norms.
- It describes situations in which group pressures for conformity deter the group from critically appraising unusual, minority, or unpopular views.
- Groupthink is a disease that attacks many groups and can dramatically hinder their performance



GROUP DECISION MAKING — RELATED CONCEPTS

- **Group shift**
- Group shift is a psychological phenomenon that occurs when group members' attitudes or decision-making strategies shift and become more extreme after group discussion, compared to their initial individual preferences
- Shift can be towards caution or risk
- Group shift can also lead to group polarization

2018 GOOGLE WALKOUTS

- On November 1, 2018, more than 20,000 [Google](#) employees engaged in a worldwide [walkout](#) to protest the way in which the company handled cases of sexual harassment, and other grievances
- The protest came one week after a [New York Times](#) report named [Andy Rubin](#) as having been paid a \$90 million severance package despite being asked to resign due to sexual misconduct allegations
- As well as other executives with similar allegations towards them who also received severance packages.

2018 GOOGLE WALKOUTS

- The walkout was organized in less than three days and lasted for a half hour.

Striking workers used a flyer that read:

Hi. I'm not at my desk because I'm walking out in solidarity with other Googlers and contractors to protest sexual harassment, misconduct, lack of transparency, and a workplace culture that's not working for everyone. I'll be back at my desk later. I walked out for real change.^[17]

[Google employees waiting to see how company will respond to walkout - YouTube](#)